

The Global Burden of Mental Illness: Prevalence, Impact, and the Tre

Global data overview (2023) for public health policy analysts and mental health program planners

Source: Our World in Data — Mental Health

Authors: Saloni Dattani, Lucas Rodés-Guirao, Hannah Ritchie, and Max Roser (2023)

Data source: IHME, Global Burden of Disease (2025)

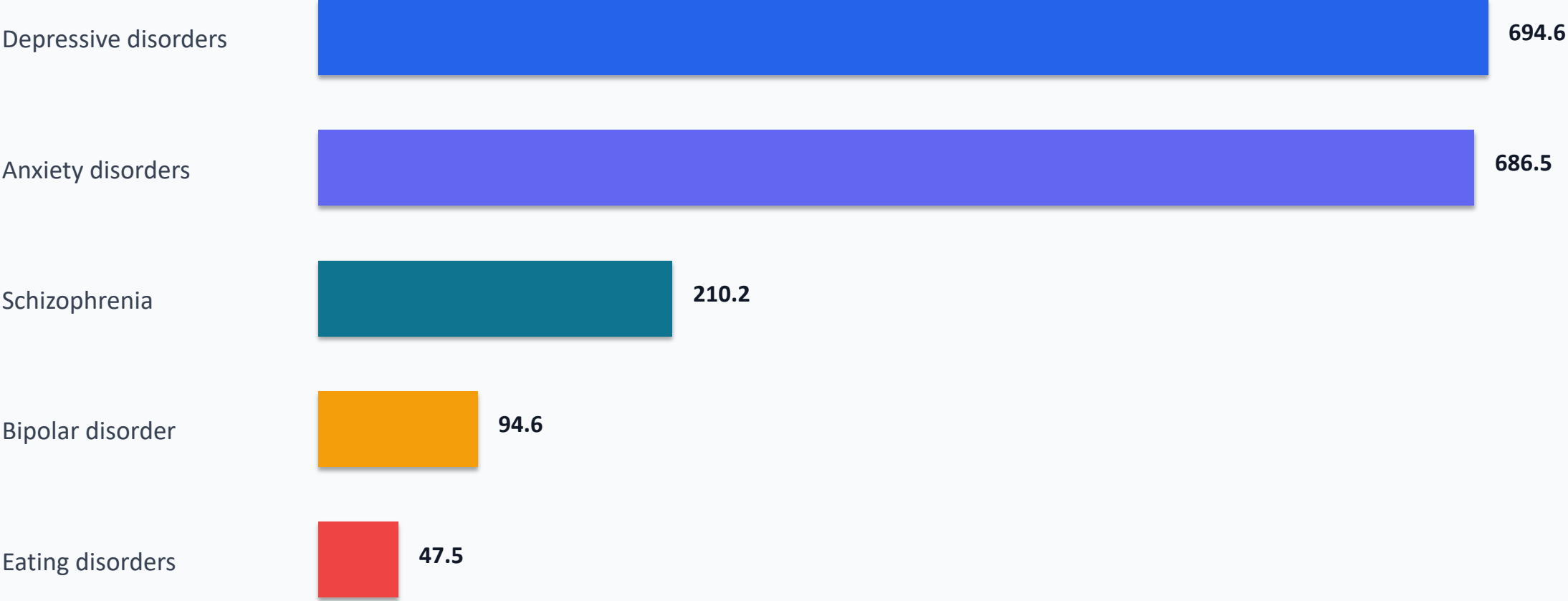
Hundreds of Millions Affected: 1 in 3 Women and 1 in 5 Men Face Ma

**1 in 3
Women**

**1 in 5
Men**

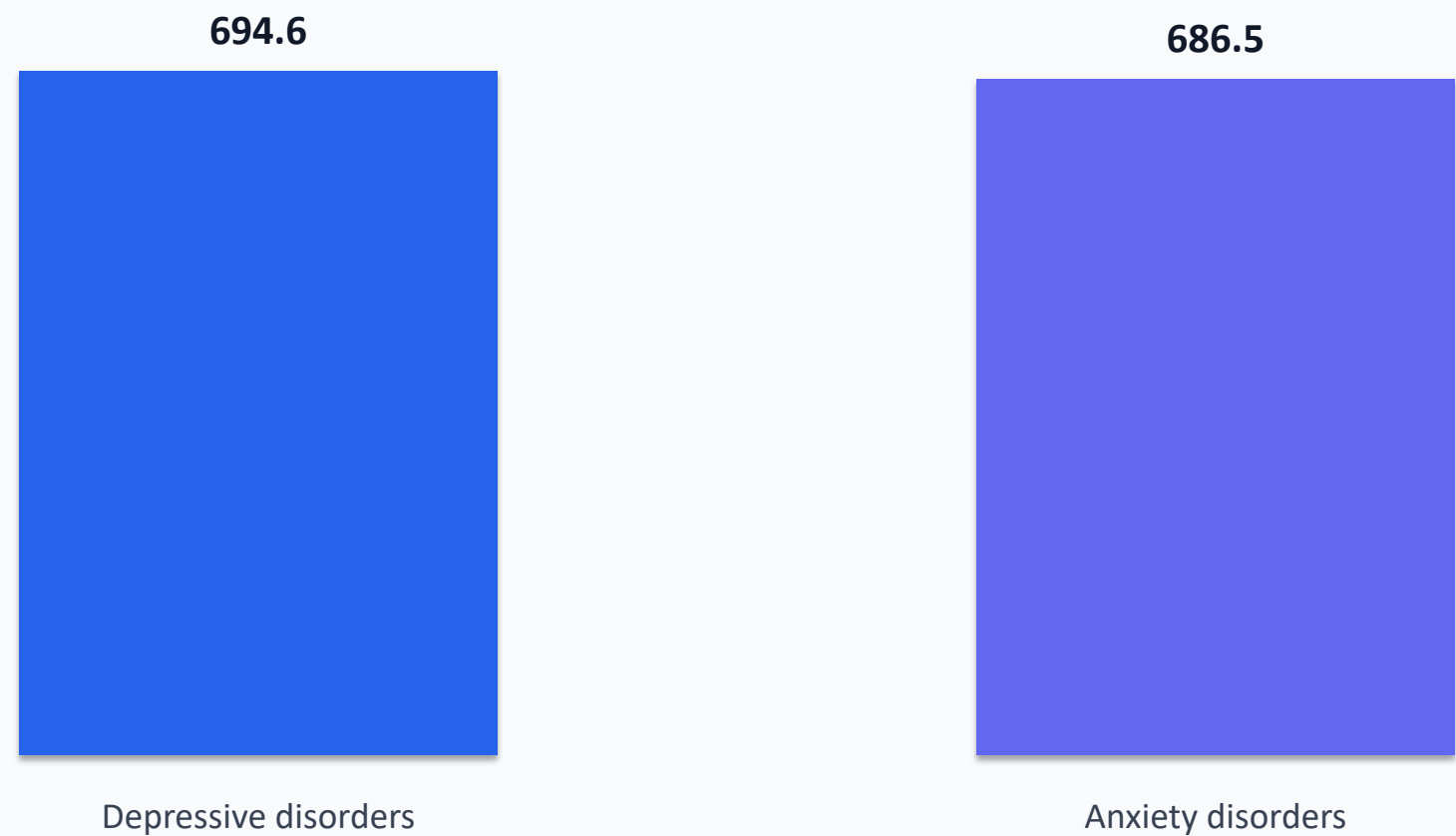
Lifetime major depression risk is substantial globally, underscoring the scale of unmet need. Mental health conditions span common disorders (depression, anxiety) and less common but severe conditions (schizophrenia, bipolar disorder).

Depression and Anxiety Dominate: ~695 and ~687 DALYs per 100K Residents



DALYs per 100,000 people (World, 2023). Reference: source brief figure_1.

Depression and Anxiety Carry Nearly Equal Disease Burden Worldwide



Together, depression and anxiety account for roughly 80% of DALYs across the five categories shown.

Schizophrenia and Bipolar Disorder: Lower Prevalence but Severe Ind

Schizophrenia: 210.2 DALYs per 100,000

**Bipolar disorder: 94.6 DALYs per
100,000**

Population-level DALYs are lower than depression/anxiety, but these disorders are associated with substantial disability and severe

Treatment Is Available but Often Lacking or Poor Quality



Treatable conditions

Mental illnesses are treatable and their impact can be reduced.



Stigma barrier

Many people feel uncomfortable sharing symptoms.



Access and quality gaps

Treatment is often lacking, or available care is poor quality.



Data challenge

Underreporting makes true prevalence harder to estimate.

How People Cope: From Medication to Faith to Family Conversations

Prescribed medication

Common in higher-income settings

Religious or spiritual activities

Prevalent in many regions worldwide

Talking to friends or family

Widely reported coping mechanism

Coping patterns vary across countries and cultures; policy responses should avoid one-size-fits-all approaches (source brief figure_2).

Key Takeaways: Prioritizing Depression, Anxiety, and Closing the Treatment Gap

Depression and anxiety are the dominant contributors to global mental health DALYs (~695 and ~687 per 100,000).

Schizophrenia and bipolar disorder contribute lower population DALYs but carry high individual disability burden.

Effective treatment exists, yet access is often limited and care quality can be inadequate.

Stigma suppresses help-seeking and contributes to underreporting, so true burden may be underestimated.

Policy should scale evidence-based interventions for common disorders while maintaining specialized care for severe conditions.